NO. 159 · SINGAPORE

THE CURRENT BRIEFING OF

MERIDIAN

Twelve desks. One world.

WEDNESDAY 11 NOVEMBER 2026



SEVEN HUNDRED SHOPS, FIFTEEN FIRES, AND NOTHING STOLEN (P3)

THE WORLD

France names two Revolutionary Guard units for wrecking the refrigeration of 700 food shops in one night

SINGAPORE

MAS opens a 500-tonne vault to foreign central banks' gold, on the day gold fell 2.64 per cent

THE MACRO DESK

American inflation was published on Tuesday with no annual rate at all: last October was never collected

Source: REUTERS/Stéphane Mahé, via Al Jazeera. A Coopérative U store with its frozen aisles closed off, 12 October 2026.

THIS ISSUE · NO. 159

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A STRAIGHT NEWS BOOK. No theme imposed, after three issues that carried one. France names the units that warmed 700 shops' fridges (p3); Singapore opens a vault it cannot yet name a customer for (p5); and Korea finds that a fixed price moves the money to a cheaper word (p21).

FROM THE DESK

"… you must never forget that every one of these figures comes in the first instance from the village watchman, who just puts down what he damn pleases."

Widely attributed to Sir Josiah Stamp (1880–1941). The attribution is contested — which, this issue, is rather the point.[1]

For p14, where last October was never collected, and p5, where a breach is a percentage of a number nobody will give.

THE STRIP · AT TUESDAY'S CLOSE

US 10-year[2]	4.98%	▲ 10bp
US 10-year real[2]	2.78%	▲ 12bp
Implied breakeven[2]	2.20%	▼ 2bp
VWRA[3]	$186.90	▼ 0.34%
AGGU[3]	$5.82	▼ 0.34%
Gold[3]	$4,031.06	▼ 2.64%
Bitcoin[4]	$73,862	▼ 1.35%
Straits Times[3]	5,258.59	▲ 0.14%

The breakeven is our own subtraction of the real curve from the nominal, not a published series (p14). Gold is a dealer price. Not advice.[3]

FROM THE ARCHIVE · WEDNESDAY

No. 110, 21 September 2026, is the issue a reader broke. He had noticed that one restaurant had been reviewed here four times in thirteen issues, and that another had been named in eighteen separate editions.

It earned its keep again today (p20): of six candidates worked up for this issue, three had already appeared here and a fourth was dropped over a name collision.

SOURCES 1 **Conventionally attributed to Sir Josiah Stamp, the British economist and Inland Revenue official; this desk could not establish a primary printing under his name**, and the wording varies between versions. It is printed as an attributed saying rather than a verified quotation. 2 The United States Treasury's own daily par yield and real yield curve files for 10 November 2026, read at source; **the breakeven line is this desk's subtraction of the real curve from the nominal one, a proxy for and not a reading of the published series** (p14). 3 Levels at Tuesday 10 November, each read at source and set out on p14; **VWRA and AGGU are delayed quotes rather than official London closes, and gold is a dealer price rather than the London benchmark.** 4 Bitcoin is a single snapshot taken at 21:08 UTC on 10 November, not a close.

THE WORLD · FRANCE AND THE GUARD

France names an IRGC cyber unit for sabotaging 700 supermarkets' fridges

Paris prosecutor Laure Beccuau has asked for international arrest warrants. The state's cyber-crisis centre counts at least fifteen fires and tens of millions of euros of ruined food from one October night.

France's government said on Monday 9 November that two offensive units inside Iran's Revolutionary Guard wrecked the refrigeration of about 700 French food shops overnight on 11–12 October. The next day the foreign minister, Jean-Noël Barrot, summoned Iran's ambassador to lodge what he called a very strong protest. Tehran's foreign ministry dismissed the charge the same day as baseless and malicious.[1]

What separates this from the usual run of state hacking is that nothing was stolen. The target was the machinery that keeps food cold, and the damage was physical: at least fifteen fires, and tens of millions of euros of meat, fish and chilled meals carried out to the bins. Barrot called it the first large-scale cyberattack aimed at sabotage on French soil — the point at which an intrusion stops being an information problem and becomes a refrigeration one.[2]

The mechanism was mundane. Cold aisles are run by small networked controllers that hold temperature and schedule the defrost cycles that clear ice off the coils. Investigators say the attackers reached those controllers and drove them into indefinite defrost — in roughly 150 Intermarché branches, cabinets were pushed to about 50°C and held there some six hours. Heat in a sealed cabinet full of grease and packaging is how a chiller becomes a fire.[3]

Casino, Leclerc, Coopérative U, Metro, Carrefour and Intermarché are all named, with butchers and a slaughterhouse. The spread inside each chain was narrow: Carrefour counted 80 of its 6,000 shops. A second wave on 2 November hit at least nine other European countries, and a separate incident altered settings at three sites of France's blood service — which Paris has attributed to nobody.[1]

> *Nothing was stolen. The target was the machinery that keeps food cold.*

BEIJING — XINHUA

China's wire leads on the denial rather than the charge. Iran's ministry gets the length of the piece to reject a "baseless and malicious" accusation and promise "necessary and appropriate" measures; France's evidence appears in a short closing section.[4]

THE CHATTER · WHAT THE TRADE SAYS ABOUT THE FRIDGE CONTROLLERS

The security trade spent the month on the hardware, not the flag. Claroty's Team82 disclosed three flaws in the **Danfoss AK-SM 800A** refrigeration manager in August, saying it reached "the device's full administrative interface and every management function it exposed", and counted **2,765** units answering from the open internet. SOCRadar found **2,898** Danfoss service banners in France — about 65 per cent of 4,481 worldwide. Huntress's **Muhammad Yahya Patel** called it the sabotage frontier the industry had warned about.[5]

THE SCEPTIC · THE SUPERMARKET FRIDGES WERE OPEN BEFORE IRAN ARRIVED

The case against France's attribution is not that Iran is innocent; it is that these supermarket fridge controllers were reachable by anyone. Kévin Tellier of Synacktiv says the problem "had been known for years" — his firm published flaws in the same Danfoss line in May 2023, and some units can only be patched by a technician on site with a USB stick. Claroty documented a hidden login path deriving a new password from the date; American cyber authorities warned about that password in May 2025. Danfoss describes "a limited number of affected systems", against the state's far larger count.[6] **The testable part:** a parallel campaign against more than 100 American water systems in July was blamed on Iran by private analysts, and the United States government has attributed it to nobody.[7]

SOURCES 1 The French state cyber-crisis centre's own advisory CERTFR-2026-CTI-009, published 9 November 2026, **read at source**, for the named units, the victim list, the ~700 sites, the fifteen fires, the second wave and the blood-service incident; **its indicator detail sits in a linked PDF this desk did not open.** 2 Agence France-Presse via the Taipei Times, 11 November, read at source, for Barrot's confirmation and wording. 3 Al Jazeera, 10 November, read at source, for the summons, the defrost mechanism and Beccuau's request for warrants. **Dates differ between outlets: this desk takes the attribution as 9 November and the summons as 10 November.** 4 Xinhua's English service, 11 November, read at source. 5 The Stack and SOCRadar, read at source, for Claroty's August disclosure and the exposure counts. 6 WeSpeakIoT on Synacktiv's findings, read at source. 7 The Register, 9 November, read at source. **Iranian state media returned 503 throughout, so no Iranian primary source appears here.**

THE WORLD · PARAGUAY AND UENO BANK

Paraguay's Senate removes President Santiago Peña over Ueno Bank's collapse

Vice-President Pedro Alliana was sworn in on 6 November. Nearly three million depositors were locked out, and about $850m of public money was sitting in the bank when it failed.

Paraguay's Senate voted unanimously on Friday 6 November to strip President Santiago Peña of office for malfeasance, and swore in his vice-president, Pedro Alliana, to serve out the term to August 2028. A judge, Humberto Otazu, ordered Peña held at a military facility the next day; police searched his house on the Sunday.[1]

The thing that removed him was a bank. Ueno had grown into one of the country's largest, and when the central bank found it below its minimum solvency and stepped in, roughly three million customers — close to half the population — found their money frozen. A bank failure becomes a constitutional event when the state's own cash is inside it: about $850m of public funds, including state pensions, sat at Ueno in June.[1]

The detail that made the politics unanswerable was personal rather than systemic. Peña took two loans of about $500,000 each from Ueno in 2024, on repayments of some $38,000 a month — roughly six times his presidential salary. Investigators have also pointed to $146m of questionable related-party lending inside the bank.[1]

The sequence was quick even by the standards of a parliamentary removal: the Senate refused to let him resign on 5 November, removed him on the 6th, and watched him detained on the 7th. Refusing the resignation mattered — it kept him inside the process rather than letting him leave it.[1]

$850m

OF PUBLIC MONEY, INCLUDING STATE PENSIONS, SITTING INSIDE UENO BANK WHEN THE CENTRAL BANK STEPPED IN[1]

ASUNCIÓN — AL JAZEERA

The opposition senator **Rafael Filizzola**, quoted as the vote went through: "We are facing the biggest corruption scandal in our democratic history."[1]

THE SCEPTIC · PEÑA FELL FASTER THAN THE DEPOSITORS WERE REPAID

The tidy reading is that Paraguay's institutions worked. The depositors' ledger says the political reckoning simply moves faster than the financial one. Of roughly three million customers locked out of Ueno, **1.2 million** had been refunded when the figures were last given, for **$158m** paid — against the **$850m** of public money alone that was inside. A president can be removed in a day; a deposit guarantee pays out over months, and no recovery timetable for the remainder has been published. **What would settle it:** the share of the $850m the state actually recovers, and whether the $146m of related-party loans is ever collected rather than merely counted.[1]

ALSO ON THE DESK

Abu Dhabi. The trilateral previewed in No. 158 convened on 10 November and ran about four hours. Sergei Lavrov rejected Europe's demand for an immediate ceasefire; Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Washington had asked whether Ukraine would "trade the Donbas for security", and answered no.[2]

Jerusalem. The 26th Knesset was sworn in on 10 November. Gadi Eisenkot's Yashar filed **61 signatures** demanding an early election — one more than half the house — while President Herzog urged leaders to do "everything possible to avoid a repeat election".[3]

Antalya. COP31 opened on 9 November and runs to the 20th, with about 200 countries and more than **90,000** people expected. The UN climate chief, Simon Stiell: "Progress is nowhere near far enough or fair enough."[4]

Madrid. Spain asked its data-protection agency on 10 November to suspend TikTok temporarily, after the fact-checking outfit Maldita.es monitored the app for 35 days and reported more than **20,000** suspected paedophile profiles and over a thousand abuse videos with 48 million views.[5]

Kuwait City. The Gulf Co-operation Council agreed on 10 November to put an advanced Unified Military Command headquarters in Kuwait, thirteen years after the command was created.[6]

SOURCES 1 Al Jazeera's explainer of 9 November 2026, **read at source**, for the Senate votes of 5 and 6 November, Alliana's swearing-in and term end, Judge Otazu's detention order, the search of Peña's house, the ~3m frozen customers, the 1.2m refunded and $158m paid, the ~$850m of public funds, the $146m of related-party loans, the two ~$500,000 loans and their ~$38,000 monthly repayments, and Senator Filizzola's remark. **This page rests on one outlet.** Paraguay's own central bank and Senate pages were not read, and the figures should be treated as that outlet's reporting rather than as official returns. 2 Al Jazeera and France 24's live file, 10 November, both read at source; CBS News, read at source, for Lavrov's refusal and Zelenskyy's account of the Donbas question. 3 Al Jazeera, 10 November, read at source. 4 UN News, read at source. 5 Al Jazeera, 10 November, read at source; the monitoring figures are Maldita.es's, as reported. 6 Al Jazeera, 10 November, read at source.

SINGAPORE · THE GOLD VAULT

MAS opens Singapore's 500-tonne currency vault to foreign central banks' gold

Six founding clearing banks are named, among them Deutsche Bank and J.P. Morgan. Trading is due to go live in the first quarter of 2027, with a tax waiver following in April.

The Monetary Authority of Singapore said on Tuesday 10 November that it will open the national currency vault — capacity of up to 500 tonnes, and extendable — to foreign central banks, international financial institutions and sovereign entities wanting somewhere to keep their gold. Selected bullion banks based here will be offered custody accounts too.[1]

Central banks have bought gold heavily for a decade, and where the metal sits has become a political question as much as a logistical one. London and New York hold most of it; Singapore is offering a third address in Asia and pairing the steel with the plumbing. Six banks, three local and three foreign, are building a system to settle gold trades between institutions, and the tax exemption on bullion widens to cover wholesale vaulting, refining and broking.[1]

The six are DBS, OCBC and UOB alongside Deutsche Bank, ICBC Standard Bank and J.P. Morgan. Preparations finish by end-2026, trading goes live in the first quarter of 2027, and SGX is targeting deliverable kilobar futures for the second. The tax changes start in April 2027. The release quotes nobody.[1]

Deputy Prime Minister Gan Kim Yong set the ambition deliberately low in remarks reported afterwards: Singapore "does not aim to replace other gold centres and gold vaulting services… We are an additional option that is offered to the central banks."[2] The timing was less modest than the language. Gold fell **2.64 per cent** on the same session, to $4,031.06, its worst day in weeks (p14).[3]

2,000t

COMMERCIAL GOLD-VAULTING CAPACITY ALREADY IN SINGAPORE — FOUR TIMES THE SOVEREIGN VAULT ANNOUNCED THIS WEEK[1]

THE CHATTER · WHAT THE BULLION TRADE MAKES OF THE MAS VAULT

The trade read it as a shop window rather than a warehouse, and the release's own arithmetic supports them: commercial vaults here already exceed **2,000 tonnes**, so the sovereign facility is a quarter of what the private market can hold. On the metal, **Nicky Shiels** of MKS PAMP called the run into year-end "modestly positive to sideways". The World Gold Council cut its 2026 investment-demand growth forecast on 3 November to **200 tonnes**, from 400.[4]

THE SCEPTIC · A VAULT WITHOUT A MARKET IS A WAREHOUSE

Marjorie Nadal, writing in *Chaos & Order* on 10 November, put the case against hardest: custody gold is not tradable inventory unless its owner lends, swaps or sells it. Her precedents are unkind. SGX withdrew an earlier gold futures contract in 2014 after volume reached zero; India's GIFT City bullion exchange fell from **93 tonnes** in 2024–25 to **under one tonne** the next year. On scale, 500 tonnes is a tenth of what the Bank of England safekeeps. Her real point is that the competition is legal: reserves are frozen by jurisdiction, not by burglary. **Her five tests for 2027** — clearing live, futures delivering, liquidity, refining volume, and one named central-bank user — are none of them met.[5]

ALSO ON THE DESK

SPH Media says five systems were breached and about 9 per cent of its database exposed. The first intrusion was detected on 4 November, the latest on 8 November; the data is mainly email addresses, with no payment or banking data. **It is the third Singapore disclosure in days to withhold a record count — and a percentage of an undisclosed denominator is a new species of non-disclosure, not an answer to the M1 and Doctor Anywhere silences.**[6]

Chan Tsan will run the Land Transport Authority from 1 May 2027. The Home Affairs Ministry named the 53-year-old founding head of its science and technology agency as chief-executive-designate from 1 January, succeeding Ng Lang. He inherits the autonomous-vehicle file; the 5 November Punggol simulation is still unpublished.[7]

SOURCES 1 The Monetary Authority of Singapore's own release of 10 November 2026, **read at source**, for the capacity, the eligible users, the six clearing banks, the 2027 milestones and the existing 2,000-tonne commercial capacity; **it names no spokesperson.** 2 Gan Kim Yong's remark is **second-hand and flagged as such**: the paper that published it returned 403. 3 Gold at 10 November, read at source, set out on p14. 4 Ad-Hoc-News, 10 November, read at source; **the World Gold Council's own site was not read, so its figure is at one remove.** 5 Marjorie Nadal, *Chaos & Order*, 10 November, read at source. 6 Tabla and MustShareNews. **SPH Media published no record count.** 7 The Ministry of Home Affairs' own announcement, read at source.

THE ATELIER · TIFFIN CARRIERS

Milton and Borosil sell tiffin carriers without publishing a steel grade

Elephant Box names its grade per product line and sells you the gasket. Thermos in Japan publishes heat retention to the degree; its American namesake publishes neither hours nor grade.

A tiffin carrier — the stacked steel lunch box Singapore calls a tingkat — is settled by three things its maker may never print: the grade of the steel, the thickness it was pressed from, and whether the lid has a gasket at all.

This matters because the difference between a carrier that outlives its owner and one that pits inside a year is invisible on the shelf. The deciding ingredient is nickel, which holds the film that resists salt — and a Singapore lunch is mostly salt: sambal, belacan, soy, tamarind. Cheap steel looks identical in the shop and fails at the seams.[1]

The grades run one way. **304**, sold as 18/8, carries 18–20 per cent chromium and 8–10.5 nickel. **202** drops nickel to 4–6 and substitutes manganese; **201** goes lower again. **430**, sold as 18/0, has effectively none and is the one to refuse. Over 575 hours of salt spray the low-nickel samples corroded and the 304 did not. And the field test everyone repeats is useless: 304, 202 and 201 all ignore a magnet; only 430 sticks.[1]

Wall thickness is the industry's unpublished variable — not one mainstream maker read for this page states it. The seal is the other. A clamp-handle tiffin does not seal at all: the lid simply sits on the box, which is why it carries rice perfectly and gravy not at all. A silicone gasket is the determining part, and a screw-down jar is the only design that genuinely travels with curry. The clasp fails first; Elephant Box runs a repair scheme specifically for broken latches.[2]

WHAT EACH STEP ACTUALLY BUYS

TIER	PRICE	WHAT YOU GET
Elephant Box 2L	£32.50	304 named, seals sold, 15yr
Thermos JBR-400, Japan	¥5,000	≥60°C at six hours, stated

Prices read on each maker's or stockist's own page, 10–11 November 2026. Thermos is ex-tax.[3]

THE CHATTER · WHAT OWNERS SAY ABOUT TIFFIN CARRIERS THAT LEAK

The leak question is contested on the makers' own review walls, which is unusual and useful. On Ecozoi's page, **Alissa**: "It is NOT leak proof... We got this thinking there would be a silicone gasket." Against her, **Carlos G**: "100% leak proof." Neither Milton nor Borosil publishes a grade an owner could check a complaint against.[4]

THE SCEPTIC · IN TIFFIN CARRIERS, DISCLOSURE RUNS BACKWARDS TO PRICE

The premium Western price does not buy more disclosure here. It demonstrably buys less. Black+Blum asks **£49.95** for a stainless bento and publishes neither grade nor country of manufacture; Klean Kanteen publishes no grade, no gasket material, no retention hours. Thermos in America publishes neither; Thermos in Japan prints a temperature at six hours against each model number. **Disclosure does not track price here; it tracks whether the seller knows its own factory.** The honest cut-off is three things: a published grade, a replaceable gasket, a spares channel.[5]

NEXT ON THE BENCH · VOTE FOR TOMORROW'S CATEGORY

Mortar & pestle (and the suribachi) — granite against porcelain, and why grooves do the work.

Track pumps & bicycle tools — Silca and Park Tool, and a pump sold with spare seals.

Wool blankets & throws — weight, weave and which mills still spin their own yarn.

The Singapore footnote is the unhappy one. Tingkat caterers are everywhere, at S$6 to S$8 a head a day, but not one provider's page read for this piece says the food arrives in a stacked carrier. The word now names the subscription, not the vessel.[6]

SOURCES 1 ChefPicks India's stainless-grade guide, **read at source**, for the composition ranges of 304, 202, 201 and 430, the 575-hour salt-spray result and the magnet point; AZoM's 304 datasheet corroborates. 2 MyNeeMoe's and GLOBO's construction guides and Elephant Box's own FAQ and warranty pages, all read at source, for the seal, the gasket, the 304-and-204 split, the Indian factory, the fifteen-year warranty, the sold seals and the latch repairs. **No mainstream maker read for this page publishes a wall thickness — a negative finding, not an omission.** 3 Prices read on each seller's own page: Elephant Box; Thermos K.K.'s own release (¥5,000 ex-tax, ≥60°C at six hours); Zojirushi's store (160°F after six hours; spare valve US$9.00); Appi via Shokunin. 4 Ecozoi's own review wall and JustBento, read at source. **Reddit refused every request this build; no r/BuyItForLife sentiment appears and none has been invented.** 5 The Black+Blum, Klean Kanteen and Thermos LLC pages, read at source and **all found to publish no grade.** 6 FoodLine's caterer listings, read at source; **the absence of any stated reusable carrier is this desk's reading of them.**

TECHNOLOGY · TSMC'S OCTOBER

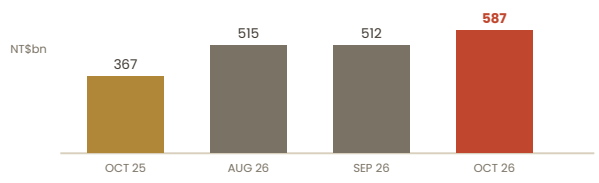
TSMC books record NT$586.9bn October revenue, up 59.7% on the year

The filing of 10 November puts January to October at NT$4.49 trillion, 43.3 per cent ahead of 2025 — and beats the company's own August record by NT$72bn.

Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Company, which makes most of the world's most advanced chips, reported on Tuesday 10 November that it sold more in October than in any month in its history: NT$586,890m, 14.7 per cent above September and 59.7 per cent above October last year.[1]

The number matters because almost nobody else can do this work, so the order book is the closest thing to a thermometer for the artificial-intelligence building boom. If the demand is genuine rather than customers hoarding parts they fear will be rationed, the boom has further to run. If it is hoarding, a great many expensive factories are being built for buyers who will not arrive.[1]

The ten-month figure carries less noise: NT$4,485,617m against NT$3,130,437m for the same period of 2025, a rise of 43.3 per cent. October displaced August's NT$514,810m. Management has guided fourth-quarter revenue to between US$52.3bn and US$54.3bn and lifted full-year growth to about 44 per cent in dollars. Demand is attributed to the smallest geometries in volume production, the ones every large accelerator is built on.[2]



Monthly revenue, NT$ billions. October 2026 is the tallest bar the company has ever printed. *Meridian* original; data from TSMC's own monthly releases.[1]

THE CHATTER · HOW THE TRADE READ TSMC'S NUMBER

Coverage was close to uniformly bullish, and mostly spent its energy on the conversion rather than the meaning: outlets reading the same NT$586.89bn published dollar equivalents between **US$17.88bn** and **US$18.4bn**, which is a reminder to quote this company in its own currency. The framing that travelled furthest was Forbes's — record sales "days before the AI chip rout" — **and this desk could not read it at source.**[2]

THE SCEPTIC · TSMC'S RECORD IS THE PLAN, NOT A SURPRISE

Lilly Mwogah of InvestingCube did the arithmetic the headlines skipped. To reach the top of its own fourth-quarter guidance, TSMC needs roughly **NT$572bn in each of November and December**. October's NT$586.89bn is therefore about **2.6 per cent** above a pace already promised — a beat so narrow it is better described as being on schedule. Her second point is duller and more useful: this is a revenue release, and it "does not show how much TSMC earned on those sales". **What would settle it:** the November figure, due in early December, against that NT$572bn run-rate.[3]

ALSO ON THE DESK

Nvidia's independent directors named their investigators on 10 November — Wachtell, Lipton, Rosen & Katz and Joon H. Kim, a former acting US Attorney. Senators Jim Banks and Elizabeth Warren demanded on the 9th that Commerce "close export control loopholes".[4]

The Singapore thread now has a name and an address. Megaspeed's Australian subsidiary lists a sole director, Kai Kang, 29, at a Sydney address shared with more than forty other businesses; regulator mail has been undeliverable since January.[5]

Beijing's own export-control consultation closes on 15 November. Announcement No. 48, issued on 16 October, proposes 40 technologies for the restricted-export catalogue — **23 of them artificial intelligence** — excluding anything already public.[6]

SOURCES 1 TSMC's own October revenue release on pr.tsmc.com and the matching Form 6-K filed with the United States Securities and Exchange Commission on 10 November 2026, **both read at source and reconciled line by line**, for NT$586,890m, the 14.7% and 59.7% changes, the January–October NT$4,485,617m against NT$3,130,437m, and the 43.3% rise. 2 Crypto Briefing and InvestingCube, both 10 November and both read at source, for the fourth-quarter guidance range, the ~44% full-year expectation, August's NT$514,810m prior record and the two different dollar conversions. **Forbes returned 403, so its framing is reported from a search summary and not from the article.** The node attribution is the trade press's, not the company's release. 3 Lilly Mwogah, InvestingCube, 10 November 2026, read at source, for the NT$572bn run-rate arithmetic and the revenue-is-not-earnings point. **A second TSMC release the same day, on board resolutions, returned 404, so no capex or dividend figure is printed here.** 4 Nvidia's own two statements of 8 and 10 November on nvidianews.nvidia.com, and Senator Banks's office's press release of 9 November, all read at source. 5 ABC News (Australia), 10 November, read at source. **Culper Research's underlying report returned 403 and was read only as summarised by TechCrunch.** 6 Announcement No. 48 of 2026 on mofcom.gov.cn, read at source, for the 40 technologies, the 23/12/5 split, the open-source exclusion and the 15 November closing date; **the parameter and node thresholds reported elsewhere sit in an annex file the page does not inline and were not obtained.**

THE HOME LAB · HOME ASSISTANT'S NOVEMBER

Home Assistant renames your entities and folds HACS into a Marketplace

The release of 4 November adds 38 integrations and Matter 1.5 cameras; a patch followed on the 9th, and the forum thread objecting to the renaming runs to nineteen replies.

Home Assistant, the open-source program a great many people use to run the lights, locks and sensors in their houses, shipped its November release on the 4th and did two things at once: it absorbed the unofficial add-on shop the community had run for years, and it started composing the names of the things in your house for you. A patch followed on 9 November.[1]

The first change is housekeeping. Anything the core project did not ship used to be installed through a volunteer-run catalogue users added themselves; that catalogue is now built into the settings menu, free. The second change is the one people mind. The software now composes each item's display name from its device and its room instead of using whatever the owner typed — and people who spent years naming several hundred switches by hand have opinions about that.[1]

The underlying identifiers do not change, and the old `friendly_name` field survives while marked for removal. The rest is the usual dense list: 38 new integrations, Matter 1.5 cameras with live video, LoRaWAN support with a network map, and local drives usable for backups. The breaking changes repay reading first — Z-Wave needs a newer server, and sun and calendar offsets quietly change meaning.[1]

3,650

DAYS — THE DEFAULT LIFESPAN OF A LONG-LIVED ACCESS TOKEN, IN A STORE THE RESEARCHER BELOW FOUND IN CLEARTEXT[4]

THE CHATTER · THE FORUM THREAD ABOUT HOME ASSISTANT'S RENAMING

The community argument has a title and a date: "WTH are you forcing naming schemes on us?", opened on the project's own forum by **Rusty** on 29 October, 19 replies, the opening post carrying 41 votes. **Hellis81**, the most-upvoted reply: "Why can't it keep it for legacy devices and entities." **Mayhem_SWE**: "Enforcing name concatenation is a terrible, terrible idea." It is not unanimous — **jthoward64** calls the change "long overdue and… a big improvement for HA in the long term."[2]

THE SCEPTIC · HOME ASSISTANT'S MARKETPLACE PUBLISHES NO RULES

In No. 158 this desk said it would watch for the first listing the Marketplace refused. There is nothing to refuse against. Reading the release post's Marketplace sections at source, neither states a listing or removal policy, nor who decides. The only governance language is a first-run notice that community projects are "not tested, audited, or supported by the Home Assistant project". Folding the shop into the house does not make the shop vetted.[3] Separately, a researcher writing as **knell** tested this exact release and reported that the authentication store holds refresh-token secrets and signing keys in cleartext, and that all four password-change paths rehash without revoking anything.[4]

ALSO ON THE BENCH

Memory is now the home lab's worst line item, and the ladder has inverted. Framework raised prices on its 16, 32 and 48GB memory modules on 6 November, the second rise this year, blaming an imbalance it says new supply is "years away" from fixing. The inversion is the tell: on TrendForce's spot table read on 10 November, **DDR4 at 79.99 trades above DDR5 at 60.167** — the older part costing more, because nobody is making it any more.[5]

Ollama shipped v0.40.16 on 9 November, adding Ricursive Intelligence's 65-billion-parameter Ripple Preview, and cutting about **27GiB** off what Qwen3.8 Flash Next needs on Apple silicon — which decides whether that model fits a 64GB machine at all.[6]

Still held: Samsung's SmartThings paywall, due 15 December, has a notice but no price.[7]

SOURCES 1 Home Assistant's own 2026.11 post of 4 November and its changelog, **both read at source**, for the Marketplace migration, the 38 integrations, the display-name change, the Z-Wave minimum and the offset changes; the patch is dated 9 November. 2 The Home Assistant Community thread "WTH are you forcing naming schemes on us?", opened 29 October, **read at source** for every quotation and vote count. 3 The Marketplace sections of that post; **the absence of a listing policy is this desk's own negative finding, not a statement by the project.** 4 "Home Assistant: the password is not the key", oss-security, 8 November, read at source, tested against core 2026.11.0. **This desk did not reproduce the findings.** 5 Framework's own post, updated 6 November; **no dollar figures of its own.** TrendForce's spot table; **it states neither currency nor unit.** 6 Ollama's v0.40.16 notes. 7 Samsung's notice; **no price.**

THE KIT · SCHIIT'S MAGNI 6

Schiit prices the three-watt Magni 6 at $99

The launch of 30 October undercuts the $119 Magni Unity it replaces, adds half a watt, and carries a three-year warranty — but reviewers question its showcase socket.

Schiit Audio put a new headphone amplifier on sale on 30 October at $99, twenty dollars below the model it replaces, and the reviews landed through the first week of November. A version with a digital input built in costs $169.[1]

A cheap amplifier is worth a page because this is where the buy-once argument is easiest to get wrong. What you pay for is the ability to drive a demanding pair of headphones without the sound thinning out, and the honest measure of that is power into a given load. The new model delivers three watts into the load most full-size headphones present, against two and a half from the outgoing one — more power for less money, which is not the usual direction of travel.[1]

The published figures are good: 3.5W into 16Ω, 3W into 32Ω and 500mW into 300Ω; distortion below 0.0001 per cent on low gain; a discrete circuit on a linear supply; switchable preamp outputs. Returns run fifteen days less a fifteen per cent restocking fee, and the warranty is three years. The outgoing Magni Unity was $119.[2]

<0.1Ω vs <2Ω

OUTPUT IMPEDANCE ON THE QUARTER-INCH JACK AGAINST THE NEW 4.4MM "HALO" SOCKET — THE PAGE'S WHOLE ARGUMENT[1]

THE CHATTER · THE MAGNI 6 LANDED IN A CROWDED WEEK

The audio press treated it as one of four launches in a single week, alongside Pro-Ject's revived Debut Carbon at $649 and iFi's UP Travel Max at £129 — a cluster The Gadgeteer rounded up on 9 November, confirming the Magni 6's prices and power table. **The measurement community has not landed yet:** a Super Best Audio Friends thread titled "Schiit Magni 6 and Mesh 2 Review and Measurements" exists, but the host refused this desk, and no Head-Fi or Audio Science Review thread had surfaced when the page closed.[3]

THE SCEPTIC · THE MAGNI 6'S BEST SOCKET MAY BE ITS WORST

The feature Schiit is selling is the one reviewers would steer you away from. The new 4.4mm "Halo" output measures **below 2Ω** of source impedance, against **below 0.1Ω** on the ordinary quarter-inch jack. With sensitive in-ear monitors — the low-impedance headphones a lot of buyers own — a source impedance in that range can audibly shift the frequency response, so the premium socket is the compromised one. Ecoustics reports that Schiit's own testing of the Halo topology produced "mixed results", notes that headphones show far less impedance variation than loudspeakers so any benefit is harder to establish, and says flatly that the design "is not proof of better sound". It also points out that a 4.4mm jack does not imply a balanced circuit. **The buy-once reading:** ninety-nine dollars buys the better-measuring output; the glamorous one is the compromise.[4]

ALSO ON THE SHELF

Pro-Ject has revived the original Debut Carbon at $649, keeping the 8.6-inch carbon arm and a factory-fitted Ortofon cartridge, with no built-in phono stage. The step-up EVO 2 is $699 — a fifty-dollar gap that makes the reissue nostalgia rather than value. **The price is not on Pro-Ject's own page.**[5]

iFi's UP Travel Max sends or receives at £129 — a 25.7-gram switchable Bluetooth bridge carrying aptX Lossless and LDAC. The maker names neither the chip part numbers nor a launch date.[6]

Still held, fourth issue: no independent measurement of Audio-Technica's flagship has appeared, though it is now on sale (p10).

SOURCES 1 Schiit Audio's own Magni 6 page, **read at source**, for both prices, the power table, the distortion figures, the output impedances on both jacks, the warranty and the returns terms. 2 StereoNET, 2 November, and ecoustics, 30 October, both read at source, for the three watts against the Magni Unity's two and a half and the outgoing pricing. 3 The Gadgeteer, 9 November, read at source. **Super Best Audio Friends returned 403, so its measurement thread was not read; no Head-Fi or Audio Science Review thread on this amplifier was found, and Reddit refused this build entirely.** 4 Ecoustics, 30 October, read at source, for the "mixed results" characterisation and the "not proof of better sound" line; the in-ear warning is also carried by Tech Times, **not read at its own host.** 5 Pro-Ject's own page for the arm and cartridge; **the prices come from The Gadgeteer, not Pro-Ject, whose page carries none.** 6 iFi's own UK page, read at source.

THE GOOD LIFE · AUDIO-TECHNICA'S FLAGSHIP

Audio-Technica puts the $3,799 cypress ATH-AWX7000 on sale in Tokyo

The 353-gram ATH-AWX7000 reached retail on 6 November and had its Japanese debut at the 42nd Autumn Headphone Festival the next day. Still nobody has measured it.

Audio-Technica's closed-back flagship went on sale on 6 November at $3,799, and was shown to Japanese listeners for the first time at the Autumn Headphone Festival in Tokyo on the 7th. This desk has carried it as an open question for four issues, waiting for a measurement; that wait continues.[1]

The object is the argument. Its ear-cup housings are turned from Kiso cypress — hinoki, the timber Japanese temples are built from — and hand-finished in Echizen lacquer, on a magnesium frame with deer-skin pads, built in Tokyo. Wood in a headphone is not decoration: the cup is an enclosure, and what it is made of changes what you hear. Whether that is true of this one is what nobody has yet tested.[1]

The specification is conventional for the money: a 58mm hybrid diaphragm pairing polymer film with a metal dome, 48Ω, 97dB per milliwatt, 5Hz to 50kHz, a thousand milliwatts maximum, 353 grams, with both a 2.5-metre balanced cable and a 3-metre single-ended one in the box. It supersedes two long-standing wooden flagships in the range.[2]

$3,799

THREE HUNDRED DOLLARS MORE THAN THE OPEN-BACKED SIBLING WHOSE MEASURED RECEPTION WAS POOR[3]

THE CHATTER · WHAT REVIEWERS HEARD IN THE AWX7000

The two reviewers who have spent time with it agree on the flaw, which is unusual. **Alex Schiffer** of Major HiFi calls the soundstage and separation "impeccable compared to other closed-back headphones" and then says plainly that "the midrange of the AWX7000 is weird", with "both male and female vocals… a strange hollowness"; his cons list reads "Vocals can sound hollow and distant" and "Pricey". **Audio46** independently describes the midrange as recessed, making vocal-heavy tracks "sound odd". **Both outlets sell the headphone**, which is worth knowing in both directions.[3]

THE SCEPTIC · THE CYPRESS IS DOING WORK THE MEASUREMENTS HAVE NOT

The craft story — Kiso cypress, Echizen lacquer, made in Tokyo — is carrying weight no measurement has yet earned. Two reviewers who heard it describe the same recessed midrange and hollow vocals, which is a tonal fault rather than a matter of taste. No independent frequency-response or distortion measurement of this model exists. And the same 58mm driver, in the open-backed ATH-ADX7000 at $3,499, met a cool reception from the measurement community, where one poster wrote: "Underwhelming measurements for sure. I don't see how it's the best headphone ever." **The testable part:** at $3,799 this costs three hundred dollars more than that sibling, and the same money buys a Focal Stellia or a Dan Clark outright. A measurement would settle it in an afternoon; four issues in, there isn't one.[3]

ALSO ON THE SHELF

Phillips finally published the two lot results this desk has been chasing. Cartier's 1924 Portico mystery clock — lot 220, the only one of six with a hexagonal rock-crystal dial, 10.6kg of gold, platinum, onyx, jade and diamonds — sold for **CHF 4,815,000** against a high estimate of CHF 3,600,000. And lot 60, an F.P. Journe Vagabondage III in diamond-set platinum, number one of ten, took **CHF 5,057,000** against a CHF 700,000 high estimate: **7.2 times** the top of its own range.[4]

Antiquorum's Geneva sale totalled CHF 9.41m on 8 November, against US$14.6m in New York three weeks earlier.[5]

Sotheby's Geneva published nothing. Its Important Watches sale of 8–9 November shows as past with no realised prices and no total. **Held rather than estimated.**[6]

SOURCES 1 Tech Times' report of the 42nd Autumn Headphone Festival, 7 November, read at source, for the 6 November on-sale date, the debut and the price; ecoustics for the materials and cables. **Audio-Technica's own pages returned 403 in both their American and Japanese forms, so no maker's press material was read.** 2 Moon Audio, an authorised dealer, corroborating the price; Audio46's review of 23 October for the driver, impedance and weight. **The announcement was 23 October in Paris; the news here is the on-sale date and the Tokyo debut.** 3 Major HiFi (Alex Schiffer, 23 October) and Audio46, read at source, for every quotation; the sibling remark concerns the ATH-ADX7000, **not this model — there is no AWX7000 measurement to cite.** Head-Fi presented a bot screen and Reddit refused this build. 4 Phillips' own lot pages for lots 220 and 60, **both read at source.** 5 Antiquorum's own homepage. 6 Sotheby's own sale page and results index, **both read at source and both carrying no total.**

SCREEN & SOUND · RAMAYANA ABROAD

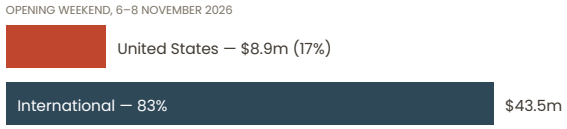
Nitesh Tiwari's Ramayana takes $52.4m worldwide but $8.9m in America

Sony opened the film on 1,433 United States screens on 5 November. Eighty-three per cent of the gross came from outside America, against a reported budget of about $430m for this half alone.

Nitesh Tiwari's *Ramayana: Rise of a Legend* opened worldwide on 5 November and took $52,439,505 in its first weekend — of which $8,939,505 came from the United States, on 1,433 screens. Ranbir Kapoor plays Ram, Yash plays Ravana, and Hans Zimmer and A.R. Rahman share the score.[1]

The number that matters is the split, not the total. This was conceived as the film that would carry an Indian epic to a general global audience, and paid for accordingly: a reported two thousand crore for this instalment, roughly $430m, self-funded by its producer. Eighty-three per cent of the opening came from outside America, most of that from India and the diaspora — a very good result for an Indian film, and not yet evidence of a crossover.[1]

One caution on the figures: a widely-quoted $12.2m American number is circulating, and it cannot be the same measure as the $8,939,505 above — almost certainly a four-day count including the Thursday. This page uses the Friday-to-Sunday basis throughout.[2]



Bars to scale. *Meridian* original; figures from Box Office Mojo's release page.[1]

17%

SHARE OF *RAMAYANA*'S OPENING WEEKEND TAKEN IN THE UNITED STATES, THE MARKET IT WAS BUILT TO CROSS INTO[1]

THE CHATTER · AUDIENCES AND CRITICS SPLIT ON RAMAYANA

The gap is the story in the reception too: a **75 per cent** critics' score on 53 reviews against **94 per cent** from more than five hundred verified audience ratings — the mirror image of the 90-against-74 split *Godzilla Minus Zero* carried in No. 158. On Letterboxd the argument is almost entirely about the visual effects, done in-house by the producer's own company: one reviewer credits an "amazing effort on CG and 3D", another that they are "the only thing about the movie that's appealing".[3]

THE SCEPTIC · RAMAYANA OPENED WELL BELOW ITS OWN TRADE BAR

The bar was set publicly before release, and the film did not clear it. The trade tracker **Venky Box Office** put the threshold at "anything below $65M overseas, including $30M in North America, would be considered a failure". The American opening came in at $8.94m against that $30m. The critical bottom is harder than 75 per cent suggests once you read the dissenters: **RogerEbert.com gave it one star in four**, calling the filmmaking "thrifty and ungenerous scene to scene"; IGN gave four out of ten. And **Professor Joyojeet Pal** of the University of Michigan argues that such films present "a sectarian, North Indian, Hindu-oriented view of India", noting Ravana is read as a hero in parts of the south — a problem for a picture sold as universal.[4]

SETTING THE RECORD STRAIGHT

No. 158 printed *Godzilla Minus Zero*'s American opening weekend as $31.61m. The settled figure is $30,587,672 — about $1.02m lower. We took an estimate for a result. The film opened on 6 November, so its second weekend is 13–15 November: there is no number yet, and this desk should not have carried one as pending.[5]

ALSO ON THE DESK

Warner Bros. opened *The Cat in the Hat* to $20,002,705 on 4,003 screens, with $10m more overseas. **No budget is published.**[5]

Queens of the Stone Age took their second United Kingdom number one with *PERFECTH*, which also topped the vinyl chart dated 6 November. **No sales figure was published, so none is printed.**[6]

SOURCES 1 Box Office Mojo's release and title pages, **read at source**, for the $8,939,505 opening, the 1,433 theatres, the dailies and the $52,439,505 total; the budget is the two-thousand-crore figure given to a Bombay High Court hearing, **at one remove.** 2 CNN, 9 November, read at syndication, carrying a $12.2m figure attributed to Deadline; **the two cannot be the same measure and have not been reconciled, so this page states its basis.** 3 Rotten Tomatoes' own page for both scores; Letterboxd for the quoted lines. **Reddit was unreachable all build, so no r/boxoffice sentiment appears in this issue.** 4 Venky Box Office via Sacnilk, 4 November; RogerEbert.com and IGN; Professor Pal via CNN. **No break-even has been disclosed.** 5 Box Office Mojo's weekend 45 table, read at source. 6 The Official Charts Company, read at source.

THE FAMILY DESK · CHATBOTS AND FEELINGS

JAMA Pediatrics links emotional chatbot use to doubled distress in 39,761 pupils

The University of Ottawa study, published 1 November, found 21.1 per cent of Ontario pupils in grades four to twelve — mean age 12.8 — had asked an artificial intelligence for emotional support.

Researchers at the University of Ottawa asked 39,761 Ontario schoolchildren whether they had ever gone to a chatbot for help with their feelings, and one in five said yes. Those children were about twice as likely to be struggling emotionally at a clinical threshold — 57.7 per cent against 29.2.[1]

The reason this lands here rather than in a technology column is the age. The children surveyed averaged 12.8 years old, which is to say they are in the first year or two of secondary school, the year a child's social life moves onto a phone. The study separates two quite different uses: asking a machine to help with homework, and asking it for comfort. Only the second shows the strong association.[1]

The important caveat is structural, not statistical. This is a cross-sectional survey — everything measured at once — so it cannot say which came first. Adjusted for demographics, loneliness, a sense of mattering and ordinary schoolwork use, the association shrinks a long way but does not vanish: a coefficient of 0.14, reported in the plain-language coverage as roughly a 26 per cent higher prevalence of clinical-level difficulty. Functional use for homework showed only a small dose-response.[1]

Prevalence at this age is rising fast enough to matter more than the effect size. Common Sense Media's 2026 census finds nearly half of nine- to twelve-year-olds have used a chatbot, rising to nearly three-quarters by thirteen; a schools survey of 5,500 puts use at 90 per cent, with nearly two-thirds turning to one both for schoolwork and when stressed or lonely.[2]

31% v 19%

SHARE OF POSTS DISCUSSING EMOTIONAL SUPPORT FROM CHATBOTS, IN TEENAGERS' OWN FORUMS AGAINST PARENTS'[3]

THE CHATTER · WHAT PARENTS MISS ABOUT EMOTIONAL CHATBOT USE

The Ottawa finding — that one pupil in five has asked a chatbot for emotional support — raises the obvious question for a parent, which is whether you would know. A September study read 1,628 posts across parenting and teenage forums and found the two groups describing different objects. Teenagers discuss receiving emotional support from a chatbot in **31 per cent** of posts, parents in **19**; parents most often discuss romantic or sexual use (**36** against 25); teenagers name attachment and dependence as a risk in 19 per cent, and describe emotional benefits in **27 per cent against the parents' five**. The authors' explanation is the useful part for a reader at home: heavy nightly use shows up as dependence, and sexual content shows up when a parent reads a log — but venting about a friend looks like any ordinary conversation, so the emotional-support use is precisely the mode parents miss.[3]

THE SCEPTIC · NOBODY CAN SAY WHICH WAY THE CHATBOT ARROW POINTS

The honest reading of 39,761 children is that we do not know which came first, and the people who ran the numbers say so first. Kayla Anderson, a psychologist and research vice-president at the JED Foundation: "It's unclear, based on these data, whether AI use is contributing to poor mental health and well-being." **Anne Maheux**, a developmental psychologist at the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill and not involved in either survey, argues the arrow may point both ways. And the lead author concedes it herself: **Kirstine Bonnesen** — "This doesn't mean that AI is causing these struggles" — adding that reaching for a chatbot "might be a sign that a young person needs more human connection and support". **Treat the finding as a prompt to ask, not as a verdict. General guidance, not medical advice.**[4]

SOURCES 1 Bonnesen K, Krygsman A, Hobson S, Korczak D, Vaillancourt T, "Affective Generative Artificial Intelligence Use and Youth Mental Health", *JAMA Pediatrics* 2026;180(11):1260–1267. **The structured abstract was read in full through the National Library of Medicine's interface; the journal page is paywalled.** Cross-sectional, four Ontario boards, May 2025 to March 2026; n=39,761, mean age 12.8; 21.1% reported affective use; unadjusted prevalence ratio 1.98 (95% CI 1.91–2.04), adjusted coefficient 0.14. **Not a trial, so no met-or-missed endpoint.** 2 The University of Ottawa release via Phys.org for the 26% framing; the prevalence figures are National Public Radio's, **read on a syndication partner because npr.org returned 503.** 3 Berkane T and colleagues, arXiv:2609.20720, 17 September 2026, read at source. **This desk could not reach the forums themselves — Reddit refused every request — so the figures are the authors' coding, not our reading.** 4 Anderson and Maheux via NPR; Bonnesen in the Ottawa release.

THE TWEEN YEARS · THE ADVERTS SHE ACTUALLY SEES

Lisa Powell's team counted 3,883 food adverts a year on children's phones

Her University of Illinois Chicago group screen-recorded 1,011 Americans aged 8 to 17, median age 12. Of the packaged foods marketed to them, 91.6 per cent failed international nutrition standards.

Researchers at the University of Illinois Chicago recorded what 1,011 American children actually saw on their phones and tablets, and counted the food adverts. The typical child met about 3,883 a year. Of the packaged products being sold to them, more than nine in ten failed the nutrition standard the researchers applied.[1]

What makes this different from every previous study of children and food advertising is the method. Earlier work asked children what they remembered, or counted what was broadcast. This one captured the screen during half an hour of ordinary leisure use and then scaled it by how long each child said they spent. The children averaged 3.7 hours a day on a phone or tablet outside school and homework — and 82.6 per cent of the advertising they met arrived through social media, where almost none of the rules that govern television apply.[1]

The distribution is where the twelve-year-old sits. Teenagers saw a median 10,107 exposures a year against children's 1,427; girls saw 8,017 against boys' 2,139. Fast food was 28.8 per cent of what appeared, sweets 20.4, drinks 20.1. And 46.9 per cent of the marketed items came from companies that have signed the industry's own voluntary pledge on advertising to children.[1]

Singapore regulates the half of this that is easiest to regulate. The Health Promotion Board's grading scheme already bans advertising of the worst-graded drinks across media, in force since December 2022 for pre-packaged drinks and December 2023 for freshly prepared ones. The extension to salt, sauces, seasonings, instant noodles and cooking oils — including an advertising ban online — **now takes effect in 2028, having previously been set for the middle of 2027**, and remains subject to consultation and gazettal. The drink is governed; the feed is not.[2]

8,017 v 2,139

MEDIAN FOOD-MARKETING EXPOSURES A YEAR, GIRLS AGAINST BOYS[1]

THE CHATTER · WHAT THE RESEARCHERS SAY SCREEN-CAPTURE COUNTING IS FOR

Lisa Powell, who directs the food-policy programme at Illinois Chicago, frames the method as the point: it "provides a real-world picture of young people's exposure across digital platforms" and "can help inform the need for policies that can protect youths from marketing of unhealthy products". She contrasts it with television, where "measuring exposure to and regulation of paid advertising ... is relatively straightforward". Her own release concedes the study "may have underestimated overall exposure" by looking only at phones and tablets.[3]

THE SCEPTIC · A HALF-HOUR CAPTURE IS AN ORDER OF MAGNITUDE, NOT AN ODOMETER

The 3,883 figure is a thirty-minute recording multiplied out to a year, and its own spread says so: the interquartile range runs from zero to 16,697. A number whose middle half spans the entire plausible range is a signal, not a measurement. The methodologists agree while defending the approach: a review by **Magdalena Muc and Mimi Tatlow-Golden** of The Open University, with colleagues at the University of Galway, examined 16 studies across four method clusters and concluded that screen capture is "currently the optimal method" while stating that "no identified method is straightforward" — each carrying trade-offs of validity, privacy and cost. **What would sharpen it:** repeated captures across days, and a laptop in the frame. **General guidance, not medical advice.**[4]

SOURCES 1 Powell LM, Marinello S, Leider J and colleagues, "Youth Exposure to Food and Beverage Marketing on Digital Media Platforms", *JAMA Pediatrics*, published online 9 November 2026, DOI 10.1001/jamapediatrics.2026.5190. **The full abstract was read through the National Library of Medicine's own retrieval interface; the journal page is paywalled.** Design: cross-sectional, November 2024 to October 2025, n=1,011 United States youths aged 8–17, median age 12 (IQR 10–15), real-time screen capture over a 30-minute leisure session extrapolated by self-reported daily screen time. Median 3,883 exposures a year (IQR 0–16,697); adolescents 10,107 against children 1,427; girls 8,017 against boys 2,139; 82.6% on social media; 2,437 of 2,660 non-restaurant items (91.6%) failed the Pan American Health Organization nutrient model; 46.9% came from signatories of the industry's own initiative. 2 The Health Promotion Board's own Nutri-Grade page, **read at source** and last updated 3 October 2026, for the beverage advertising prohibition, the December 2022 and December 2023 commencement dates, and the statement that the extension to salt, sauces, seasonings, instant noodles and cooking oils takes effect in 2028 subject to consultation and gazettal. 3 The University of Illinois Chicago's own release of 9 November, updated 10 November, read at source, for every Powell quotation and the underestimation caveat. 4 Muc M, Tatlow-Golden M, Vaughan E and colleagues, "Measuring Children's Actual Exposure to Unhealthy Food Marketing in (and With) Digital Media: A Narrative Scoping Review", *Nutrition Reviews*, online 22 January 2026, DOI 10.1093/nutrit/nuaf282, abstract read at the same interface. **No parent-forum sentiment appears on this page: Reddit refused every request this build.**

THE MACRO DESK · AN INFLATION REPORT WITHOUT INFLATION

The BLS published an October CPI with no annual rate at all

Prices rose 0.4 per cent on the month and core 0.3 per cent, both above what Wall Street expected. But October 2025 was never collected, so the Bureau could publish no twelve-month figure at all.

The United States Bureau of Labor Statistics published October's consumer price index at half past eight on Tuesday morning, 10 November, and it contained no inflation rate. Prices rose 0.4 per cent on the month and 0.3 per cent excluding food and energy — both hotter than economists expected — but the bureau could not print the number everyone quotes.[1]

The reason is a hole in last year's data. During the lapse in government funding the bureau did not collect prices for October 2025, and a twelve-month change needs both ends. So the release states plainly that it cannot publish annual changes wherever the year-ago figure is missing. A few exceptions survive where prices come from other records — petrol is up 37.4 per cent on the year — but for the index as a whole the last published annual rate remains September's 3.7 per cent. The most-watched number in markets does not exist this month.[1]

What arrived instead was a monthly print with nowhere to hide. Shelter supplied more than thirty per cent of the increase; services outside housing rose 0.5 per cent, the most since May. And Governor Christopher Waller had, that same morning in London, pre-committed: if October's core came in at 0.3 per cent or above, "hiking only 25 basis points would put our credibility at risk, a risk I am not eager to take". It came in at 0.3.[2]

The market repriced the path, not the destination. Two-year yields jumped 17 basis points to 4.73 per cent, and the whole of the ten-year's 10-point rise was real: the inflation-protected yield rose 12 points to 2.78, so the implied breakeven *fell* two to 2.20. A hot print bought less long-run inflation compensation, not more — the clearest statement a bond market can make that it expects the central bank to win.[3]

−0.34% each

VWRA AND THE GLOBAL BOND PROXY FELL BY THE SAME AMOUNT TO THE BASIS POINT — DIVERSIFICATION THAT DID NOT DIVERSIFY[3]

THE LEVELS · AT TUESDAY'S CLOSE

US 10-year[3]	4.98%	▲ 10bp
US 10-year real[3]	2.78%	▲ 12bp
Implied breakeven[3]	2.20%	▼ 2bp
VWRA[4]	$186.90	▼ 0.34%
Bitcoin[5]	$73,862	▼ 1.35%

Levels at 10 November, each read at source. The breakeven is this desk's subtraction of the real curve from the nominal one — a proxy for, not a reading of, the published series. Not advice.

THE VERDICT · WHAT IT MEANS FOR VWRA, GLOBAL BONDS, GOLD AND BITCOIN

The regime is re-tightening and the shock is in *real* rates, which is why nothing hedged anything. Global equities and global bonds fell by an identical 0.34 per cent: a real-rate move hits the common discount factor, so bonds offer no insurance against it. **Gold's $109 fall was arithmetic, not sentiment** — real yields up, dollar up, risk assets down too. Bitcoin is the same factor with more beta. **Not investment advice.**[3]

THE SCEPTIC · THE DECEMBER HIKE MAY NOT BE SETTLED

The consensus hardened within the hour — Capital Economics' **Thomas Ryan**: "This should all but confirm a December hike." Two forecasters leave the door open, and both point at one variable. **Matt Luzzetti** of Deutsche Bank keeps a December-January-March path but warns a deeper technology sell-off could force a pause. **Chris Hodge** of Natixis concedes the Fed "likely would have hiked in October without the preceding market turmoil" — conceding that financial conditions are the swing variable. **What would settle it:** the 8–9 December meeting, and November's index on 10 December — which will also be the first print in two months to carry an annual rate.[6]

SOURCES 1 The Bureau of Labor Statistics' own October 2026 release, USDL-26-1685, **read at source**, for the 0.4% headline, the 0.3% core, the shelter and services contributions, and **its own statement that it cannot publish twelve-month changes where October 2025 was never collected**; September's 3.7% stands as the last annual rate. 2 Waller's London remarks and the Fed's 28 October statement, both read at source. **FedWatch returned 503 twice, so no probability is printed.** 3 The Treasury's own par and real yield files for 10 November, read at source. **The breakeven is this desk's own subtraction, not a published series.** 4 Levels read instrument by instrument. **VWRA and AGGU are delayed quotes, not official closes; gold is a dealer price, not the London benchmark.** 5 Bitcoin at 21:08 UTC — a snapshot, not a close. 6 Yahoo Finance, 10 November, read at source.

THE INVITATION · TECHNICAL DIVING

Helium prices are pushing divers onto rebreathers, ScubaBoard's threads show

A single deep wreck dive costs about $500 in open-circuit gas against roughly $30 on a recycling loop. Some 23,000 units have sold in ten years, and Asia is the worst-supplied region on earth.

Technical diving is the branch of scuba in which you deliberately give up the right to swim straight up, and this page is about why anyone would want that. Ordinary diving always leaves the surface available. Technical diving accepts that it is not — because there is rock or steel overhead, or because rising directly would make you seriously ill — and then plans the dive so carefully that it does not matter.

Four things compound to make it a separate sport. There is a hard ceiling, physical or merely arithmetic. There is a decompression obligation, which means staged stops on the way up while absorbed gas leaves the blood. There are breathing mixtures with helium in them, because ordinary air turns narcotic and treacly to breathe at depth. And there is redundancy as doctrine: two of everything that can kill you.[1]

The interesting thing about 2026 is that the gateway has moved. It used to be depth; it is now cost. On ScubaBoard's long-running thread about the future of open-circuit trimix, the poster **Whitrzac** puts it bluntly — "There is NO reason to do OC trimix before buying a rebreather" — and prices a 160-foot wreck dive at roughly **$500 in gas against about $30** on a closed loop, which recycles your breath and adds only the oxygen you consume. **doctormike**, in the same thread: "As helium becomes harder to get, the idea of just throwing it away with every breath makes less and less sense." An instructor posting as **Tracy** says open-circuit trimix is going the way of the dinosaurs.[2]

The scale is small and the data is thin, which is itself part of the culture. A June 2026 paper in *Diving and Hyperbaric Medicine*, drawing on figures supplied by twenty of twenty-two manufacturers, counts **25,000 to 35,000 rebreather units in the market** and about **23,000 sold in ten years**, with over 5,000 rebreather certificates awarded across eight agencies last year — which the authors convert to perhaps **1,400 to 2,800 genuinely new divers a year**. The paper's own sections disagree about the active population by a factor of ten, and says so.[3]

Helium is also what decides whether any of it is practical from Singapore. Supply across the region is thin: limited in South Korea, and **not available for diving at all in Japan**, where suppliers prioritise medical use. No Singapore shop read for these pages publishes a helium or trimix fill price, which is why the regional pattern is to own the machine, fly its head, and arrange gas and absorbent with the destination in writing before booking anything.[2]

46

MEAN AGE OF A REBREATHER DIVER, 95 PER CENT OF THEM MEN — THIS HOBBY'S MEDIAN PRACTITIONER IS THIS MAGAZINE'S MEDIAN READER[3]

THE CHATTER · WHERE TECHNICAL DIVERS ACTUALLY GATHER

ScubaBoard is the centre of gravity, and its forum structure is the factional map: **268,958 registered members** and more than ten million messages, with Technical Diving at 11,269 threads, Rebreather Diving at 2,640, Cave Diving at 2,695 and — tellingly — Accidents, Incidents and Near Misses at **6,505 threads and 168,834 messages**. The trade organ is *InDEPTH*, whose 2026 rebreather guide lists **39 units**: 21 backmount, 11 sidemount, 7 frontmount. **Reddit refused this desk for the entire build, so no subscriber counts are printed here and none have been guessed.**[4]

WHAT THE NEXT TWO PAGES DESCEND INTO

The gear and the factions (p16) — what a closed-circuit rebreather costs, who makes them, and why you cannot simply buy one.

The body count and the culture (p17) — what the sport's own safety researchers can and cannot say about its dead, and where Singapore fits.

SOURCES 1 Technical Diving International's own trimix course standard, read at source, for the 60-metre depth and the oxygen fractions; Shearwater Research's own documentation, read at source, for the decompression model in general use. 2 The ScubaBoard thread "Future of OC trimix", opened 28 April 2022 and now running to thirty pages, **read at source** for all three quotations and the $500-against-$30 comparison. **Those gas costs are a forum poster's own estimate for his own dive, not a surveyed price.** 3 Tillmans F, Saraiva G, Ferguson B, Dugrenot E and Blogg SL, a review of closed-circuit rebreather accidents, *Diving and Hyperbaric Medicine* 56(2):185–190, published 30 June 2026, **read in full at the journal's own site**, for the unit counts, the ten-year sales figure, the certificate total, the new-diver estimate, the mean age of 46 and the 95 per cent figure. **The paper's abstract and its safety section imply active populations differing by roughly a factor of ten; this desk prints the discrepancy rather than choosing a side.** 4 ScubaBoard's own community statistics and forum indices, read 10–11 November 2026; *InDEPTH*'s 2026 rebreather guide, read at source.

THE DEEP END · THE MACHINES AND THE MAKERS

Fathom and JJ-CCR sell no rebreather without proof of training

Published prices run from €4,990 to $9,195, and the small workshops undercut the corporate tier. Fathom will not take a credit card; JJ-CCR sells spare parts only to its own owners.

Technical diving's equipment market is the subject of this page, and it is small enough that every serious buyer knows the maker by name — and argumentative enough that the choice of machine is a statement of allegiance.

The machine in question recycles your breath. It scrubs the carbon dioxide out with a canister of chemical granules, adds back only the oxygen you actually consumed, and so uses almost no gas — which is why it is silent, why your breath stays warm, and why helium became affordable. It is also a life-support device with several ways to kill you quietly, which is why the people who make them have made it unusually hard to buy one.[1]

Start with the prices that are actually published, because most are not. The Danish JJ-CCR lists at **€8,525** before tax; its price sheet states flatly that packages cannot be altered, that "Parts and Accessories are only sold to JJ-CCR users", and that the unit "is only sold with the proof of a Training Course". The American Fathom Mk V is **$9,195**, fully mechanical, and the company will not accept a credit card — you wire money to a small workshop after speaking to one of its instructors. Dive Rite's chest-mounted unit is **$7,200**, built to order and shipped only to the certified diver or their instructor. Divesoft's Liberty is **€9,100**; the new S7 is **€4,990**.[2]

What that list conceals is how many makers publish nothing. AP Diving, rEvo, KISS, Scubaforce, Hollis, Halcyon and Seacraft all publish specifications and no price at all. The handset market is a near-monopoly with public pricing: Shearwater's computers run from $595 to $1,950, and it even supplies the controllers inside rival rebreathers. The first credible challenge in years came on 5–6 November, when Suunto added a closed-circuit mode with a separate bail-out time-to-surface to two watches by software update.[3]

£752.51

A MADE-TO-MEASURE BRITISH DRYSUIT FROM SEASKIN, AGAINST $3,799 FOR A SANTI — THE CATEGORY'S ONE CLEAR BUY-ONCE BARGAIN[4]

THE CHATTER · WHAT JJ-CCR AND FATHOM OWNERS FIGHT ABOUT

The hottest thread in the sport is "What does GUE really stand for today?" — **621 replies** since January, still live. The critic **Maolli** summarises that agency's stance as "do it our way or do it the wrong way"; **VikingDives** jokes the initials mean "Groupthink Underwater Enterprise". The defence is narrower and more serious — **grantmac**: "It's just team diving where you know how your teammate sets up their gear and responds to situations." On the newest chest-mounted unit, **rjack321** calls it "a specialized tool for (formerly OC) sidemount divers pushing sidemount caves", while **PfcAJ** offers the drier verdict: "a specialized tool for GUE instructor revenue".[5]

THE SCEPTIC · THE REBREATHER UPGRADE TREADMILL IS REAL

Fathom's mechanical units sidestep it, but every electronic rebreather on this page — JJ-CCR included — is selling into the same unfinished problem: the genuine technology step of the year is solid-state oxygen sensing — and the community's complaint is that nobody has written the software for it. The new hybrid head pairs two conventional cells with a digital one that measures reflected light and so does not under-read when flooded. But on the forums **makar0n** notes the pricing after a distribution deal is "just silly" and that the digital units "appear to not be certified for any dive/medical/life support usage"; **Mobulai** says Shearwater "just has to either write code to deal with it, or make their os opensource", and doubts it will. On the doctrine forum, **jale**: "I got the feeling that the wheel is going to be reinvented…" **And the one thing everyone wants is still missing:** no reliable carbon-dioxide sensor inside the loop has shipped. One maker infers scrubber life from the heat of the chemical reaction instead. Any 2026 claim to have solved it is marketing.[6]

SOURCES 1 Technical Diving International's own standards and Shearwater's documentation, read at source. 2 Prices read on each maker's own page or price list: JJ-CCR's Q2 2026 list, **read at source** including its three quoted conditions of sale; Fathom's own store for the $9,195 and its payment terms; Dive Rite's page for the $7,200 and the shipping restriction; Divesoft's shop for the €9,100; *InDEPTH* for the S7's €4,990. **The S7 has no published scrubber-duration or work-of-breathing validation yet.** 3 The AP Diving, rEvo, KISS, Scubaforce, Hollis, Halcyon and Seacraft sites, **each checked and each found to publish no price**; Shearwater's own store; DeeperBlue for the Suunto mode. 4 Seaskin's own pricing and lead-time pages, read at source. 5 The ScubaBoard threads "What does GUE really stand for today?" and the chest-mount discussion, **both read at source** for every quotation. 6 ScubaBoard's sensor and doctrine threads and *InDEPTH*, read at source. **No maker read for this page ships an in-loop carbon-dioxide sensor.**

THE DEEP END · THE COST AND THE COUNT

Divers Alert Network could not classify 124 of 241 rebreather deaths

The Divers Alert Network review of June 2026 puts the rate at 1.8 to 3.8 deaths per 100,000 dives, and finds cardiac involvement the largest single cause it could identify. Singapore became the region's capital in April.

What technical diving costs, and what it costs, is this page — the money first, then the body count the sport keeps on itself. Both are published by the community rather than extracted from it, which is the most admirable thing about the culture.

The money ladder is steep but legible. A competent decompression diver on open-circuit gear is about **US$8,000 to $9,000** before cylinders; add the recycling machine and its training and the figure runs **$18,000 to $25,000**. A cave-trained diver then spends **$6,000 to $12,000 a year** on absorbent, cells, servicing and trips.[1]

Now the count. The June 2026 review in *Diving and Hyperbaric Medicine* verified **241 rebreather fatalities between 2013 and 2022**, a mean of 24 a year, and estimates **1.8 to 3.8 deaths per 100,000 dives**. Rebreather divers are perhaps a tenth to a seventh of all scuba fatalities while being a vanishingly small share of all divers. Most fatal problems began at 40 to 80 metres — but **32 began shallower than 20 metres, some during entry-level training**. The demographic is unflattering to this magazine's readership: 67 of the dead were men aged 50 to 59.[2]

The number that should stop a prospective buyer, though, is the one about evidence: **124 of the 241 cases carried too little information to classify at all.** Of the 117 that could be, cardiac involvement or questionable cardiac health was the largest single category at 29, ahead of hypoxia at 21. The sport's own safety researchers cannot say why most of its dead died.[2]

THE CHATTER · SINGAPORE QUIETLY BECAME THE REGIONAL CAPITAL

While Britain's EUROTEK conference has been dark since 2018, **TEKAsia ran at Suntec from 10 to 12 April 2026**, led by David Strike and Richard Taylor, with a speaker list of the global first rank — Jill Heinerth, Richie Kohler, Leigh Bishop — alongside a 240-metre hydrogen dive. Local training is real: **Friendly Waters** runs the full open-circuit ladder to 100 metres plus two rebreather levels; **Gill Divers** runs the alternative syllabus. Neither publishes prices.[3]

THE SCEPTIC · TECHNICAL DIVERS ADMIT THE TRAINING IS NOT THE PROBLEM

The most valuable document on this beat is a thread asking whether rebreather training teaches unsafe diving. mderrick's argument is that standards do not, but that training addresses knowledge and procedure while accidents are built from ordinary error and drift: "An excellent instructor can perfectly teach what is still a very imperfect standard." His sharpest point is that the critical failure is cognitive — the delay between *something is wrong* and *stop diagnosing and bail out now* — so a better valve solves nothing, because the delay happens before the physical act. The replies do not soften it. **OTF**, flatly: "Rebreather diving IS inherently unsafe." And on checklists, **Dsix36**, who admits he no longer uses one: "I will never rush another CCR to get ready and I will never let myself be rushed."[4]

NEXT DESCENTS · VOTE FOR TOMORROW'S HOBBY

Netsuke & miniature carving — boxwood, antler and a legal minefield, carved at thumbnail scale.

Change ringing (English tower bells) — a permutation algorithm you perform with a rope and a ton of bronze.

Origami & paper craft — a near-free deep skill with a mathematics crossover and serious paper geekery.

SOURCES 1 Prices assembled from makers' and specialist retailers' own published lists, each read at source — Shearwater, Halcyon, Dive Rite, Seaskin, Santi and Suex via Extreme Exposure, and Fathom for absorbent — and from a working instructor's own published schedule for training fees. **The ladder totals are this desk's arithmetic on those published components, not a surveyed figure.** 2 Tillmans F and colleagues, *Diving and Hyperbaric Medicine* 56(2):185–190, 30 June 2026, **read in full at the journal's own site**, for the 241 verified fatalities, the mean of 24 a year, the per-100,000 rates, the depth distribution, the age breakdown, the 124 unclassifiable cases and the cardiac and hypoxia counts. 3 The Scuba News's report of TEKAsia 2026 and the conference's own programme, read at source; DeeperBlue for EUROTEK's cancellation and the absence of any date since 2018; Friendly Waters' and Gill Divers' own course pages, **read at source and both found to publish no prices.** 4 The ScubaBoard thread "What If CCR Training Is Teaching Inherently Unsafe Diving?", opened 31 August 2026, **read at source** for every quotation.

FITNESS · THE T-REX TRIAL

Danny Green's T-REx trial kept 1.09kg of lean mass on lifters

Nature Medicine published the 120-person, 40-week randomised trial on 9 November. Both groups lost about 22kg; strength rose around a tenth with training and fell around a tenth without it.

Researchers in Perth put 120 people in their fifties and sixties on a weight-loss drug, had half of them lift weights three times a week for forty weeks, and published the result on 9 November. Both groups lost almost exactly the same weight. The lifters kept about a kilogram more lean tissue and got roughly a tenth stronger; the others got a tenth weaker.[1]

This is the question hanging over the whole class of new weight-loss injections. Dropping twenty-odd kilograms means losing fat and muscle together, and muscle is what carries you up stairs at eighty. The trial tested whether ordinary resistance training, done alongside the drug, protects the tissue you want to keep. Its answer is yes, modestly.[1]

The specifics: a two-arm randomised controlled trial, 120 men and post-menopausal women aged 50 to 70 with obesity or overweight, all prescribed tirzepatide, most titrated to 15mg weekly, the training arm working three times a week with 91 per cent adherence. The primary endpoint — total lean soft-tissue mass — **was met**, with a between-group difference of **1.09kg (95% CI 0.43–1.75)**. Weight loss was 22.28kg trained against 22.61kg untrained. Strength rose 4.7 to 8.6kg in the lifters and fell about 4kg in the drug-only arm.[1]

1.09kg

LEAN TISSUE PRESERVED — AGAINST ABOUT 22KG OF TOTAL WEIGHT LOST IN BOTH ARMS[1]

THE CHATTER · HOW CLINICIANS ARGUE ABOUT LEAN MASS ON THESE DRUGS

The clinical discourse around the T-REx question was polarised before this trial reported. Medscape's survey runs a section headed "Studies Don't Support Damaging Muscle Loss" while quoting a researcher on the other side that lean-mass loss "is a real problem for at-risk people", leading to "osteoporosis, frailty, and fractures from falling". The trial's lead investigator, **Winthrop Professor Danny Green** of the University of Western Australia, puts the premise plainly: "Loss of lean mass, including muscle, is an inevitable part of weight loss by any method."[2]

THE SCEPTIC · T-REX'S HEADLINE NUMBER IS A RELATIVE ONE

The figure that will travel — a quarter less lean tissue lost — is a relative reduction of a small absolute quantity. In kilograms the training arm preserved **1.09kg, the interval reaching down to 0.43kg**, against roughly 22kg lost, in 120 people. Three objections, none fatal: the abstract reports **no between-group difference in any functional or cardiometabolic outcome**, so lean mass is a surrogate, not an endpoint; **91 per cent adherence** is a research-grade number nobody reproduces alone; and the sceptical position holds these drugs destroy no more lean mass than any other way of losing weight — making this a general dieting finding in fashionable dress.[2]

ALSO ON THE DESK

A 162-person Hong Kong trial found one cognitive gain and no others. Twenty-four weeks of twice-weekly resistance training on unstable surfaces, in over-65s with mild cognitive impairment, improved verbal fluency by **1.2 letters**, and **nothing else reached significance**.[3]

Thirty minutes of cycling partly rescued memory after a short night. In 88 adults averaging 24, exercise before learning restored recall in the five-hour-sleep group to a level comparable with eight — **though the mediation interval is very wide.**[4]

General guidance, not medical advice. No trial here studied a drug-free reader in his forties. The transferable line is the oldest one: during any sustained weight loss, keep lifting.

SOURCES 1 Green DJ and colleagues, *Nature Medicine*, DOI 10.1038/s41591-026-04752-5. **The structured abstract was read in full through the National Library of Medicine's interface; nature.com and PubMed both refused this desk, so the full text was not read.** The University of Western Australia's release of 10 November corroborates the cohort, weights and strength figures. **The index dates it 9 November, the university 10.** 2 Medscape's survey and Professor Green's quotation in that release, both read at source. **Reddit was unreachable all build, so no forum sentiment appears here.** 3 *J Nutr Health Aging*, 7 Nov 2026, DOI 10.1016/j.jnha.2026.101030. 4 *Sleep*, 10 Nov 2026, DOI 10.1093/sleep/zsag235. Both abstracts read at the same interface.

THE DIARY · TWO DEADLINES IN A FORTNIGHT

Gardens by the Bay opens Christmas Wonderland on 27 November, still unpriced

ART SG's early-bird offer ends at 11.59pm on 24 November and halves every adult pass. The Gardens' own ticket line has read "prices will be released soon" for six issues running.

SINGAPORE

BOOK NOW · PLAN AHEAD

27 Nov–3 Jan ★ **Christmas Wonderland 2026**
SUPERTREE GROVE & THE MEADOW · **6.30PM–11PM, LAST ADMISSION 10.15PM** · THIRTEENTH EDITION, DATES CONFIRMED ON THE GARDENS' OWN PAGE · **SIXTEEN DAYS OUT AND NO TICKETS ON SALE**; THE PRICE LINE STILL READS "TICKET PRICES WILL BE RELEASED SOON"[1]

22–24 Jan ★ **ART SG 2027 · early bird ends 24 Nov**
MARINA BAY SANDS · TWO-FOR-ONE ADULT PASSES **S$40–S$44** AGAINST S$80–S$88; VERNISSAGE PASS S$94 AGAINST S$188 · **UNDER-16S FREE WITH A PAYING ADULT, BUT MUST BE REGISTERED** — THE BEST FAMILY ECONOMICS ON THIS PAGE[2]

20–29 Nov **Kalaa Utsavam · Indian Festival of Arts**
ESPLANADE · MIXED FREE AND TICKETED ON THE HOUSE'S USUAL MODEL · NO PRICES AT LISTING LEVEL[3]

1–30 Nov **Soundtracks · free programme**
ESPLANADE · SONGS FROM STAGE AND SCREEN, LISTED UNDER FREE PROGRAMMES · **THE ZERO-COST FILLER ON THIS PAGE**; INDIVIDUAL PERFORMANCE TIMES ARE NOT PUBLISHED ON THE LISTING[3]

3–6 Dec **Voices · A Festival of Song**
ESPLANADE · CHORAL, A CAPPELLA, MUSICAL THEATRE AND OPERA · VENUE AND PRICES NOT PUBLISHED ON THE LISTING[3]

15–31 Jan **Light to Night 2027 · "Pop. Power. Play."**
NATIONAL GALLERY AND ACROSS THE CIVIC DISTRICT · ELEVENTH EDITION, ALL AGES · **NO FESTIVAL PRICING PUBLISHED**; THE OUTDOOR CIVIC DISTRICT WORKS ARE FREE[4]

13–24 Jan **Singapore Fringe Festival 2027**
CONFIRMED ON ESPLANADE'S OWN FESTIVALS INDEX RATHER THAN THE ORGANISER'S SITE — **VENUE-CONFIRMED, NOT ORGANISER-CONFIRMED** · ADULT-LEANING PROGRAMMING, NOT A FAMILY PICK[3]

JAPAN & THE REGION

WORTH THE FLIGHT

11–13 Dec ★ **Tokyo Comic Con · tenth anniversary**
MAKUHARI MESSE, CHIBA · THREE-DAY PASS **¥9,900** AGAINST ¥16,500 FOR THREE SINGLE EARLY-BIRD DAYS · **UNDER-15S ¥500, ELEMENTARY-AGE FREE WITH A GUARDIAN** · PHOTO TICKETS ARE SEPARATE AND STEEP, TO ¥34,000 · TWO ANNOUNCED GUESTS HAVE SINCE CANCELLED[5]

10–24 Jan **Hatsu Basho · tickets open 5 December**
RYOGOKU KOKUGIKAN, TOKYO · **ADVANCE SALES 5 DEC**, AND THE SUMO ASSOCIATION'S OWN SITE RECORDS NOVEMBER AS SOLD OUT ON EVERY DAY — SET AN ALARM · CHAIR SEATS BEAT BOX SEATS WITH A CHILD[6]

4–11 Feb ★ **Sapporo Snow Festival 2027**
ODORI, TSUDOME AND SUSUKINO · **VIEWING IS FREE; THE SITE STATES NO ADMISSION CHARGE** · TSUDOME IS THE SLIDES-AND-SNOW-PLAY SITE · **BOOK SAPPORO BEDS NOW** — THIS IS THE CITY'S TIGHTEST WEEK[7]

7 MAR **Tokyo Marathon 2027 · volunteer window**
RUNNER ENTRY CLOSED IN SEPTEMBER; ONE LIVE WINDOW REMAINS — **OVERSEAS VOLUNTEER ENTRY TO 23 NOVEMBER, 5PM JAPAN TIME**, REQUIRING MEMBERSHIP FIRST · **AN EARLIER NOTICE ON THE SAME SITE SAID 15 NOVEMBER; THE CONFLICT IS UNRESOLVED**[8]

25–27 Mar **Art Basel Hong Kong 2027**
DATES CONFIRMED ON THE FAIR'S OWN PAGE, WHICH PUBLISHES **NO VENUE AND NO TICKET INFORMATION** — NEWSLETTER SIGN-UP ONLY[9]

9–11 Apr **Hong Kong Sevens 2027 · Kai Tak**
THE ORGANISER'S PAGE SAYS ONLY "TICKETING DETAILS TO FOLLOW" — NO BALLOT, NO ON-SALE DATE · **A STANDING ALARM**: THE NEW STADIUM'S FIRST SEVENS CYCLES WERE HEAVILY OVERSUBSCRIBED[10]

PLANNING NOTES · WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT THIS FORTNIGHT

Two hard deadlines inside a fortnight. ART SG's early bird closes 24 November and halves every price but the top pass; the Tokyo Marathon's overseas volunteer window closes the same week. **One alarm to set:** 5 December, when January's sumo goes on sale — November sold out on every single day. **One to hold loosely:** Christmas Wonderland opens 27 November with no published price and no tickets on sale, so hold the evening but promise nothing. **Best value for a twelve-year-old:** the free registered children's pass at ART SG and the ¥500 junior ticket at Tokyo Comic Con. **Hotel pressure points:** Sapporo for 4–11 February and Tokyo for 10–24 January. **Not listed, deliberately:** three stadium concerts circulating with dates and prices — every primary ticketing route refused us, and an unverified date is not a listing.

SOURCES Every event was re-verified on its promoter's, venue's or official ticketing page on 10–11 November 2026, and the wording quoted is theirs. 1 Gardens by the Bay's own Christmas Wonderland page, **read at source**, for the dates, hours, last admission and the price sentence quoted verbatim. 2 ART SG's own site and tickets page. 3 Esplanade's own listings for Kalaa Utsavam, Soundtracks and Voices, and its index for the Fringe. 4 The National Gallery's own Light to Night page; **the older URL now 404s.** 5 Tokyo Comic Con's own ticket and home pages, including its 20 October cancellation notice. 6 The Japan Sumo Association's own ticket service and site; **January prices are not listed.** 7 The Sapporo Snow Festival's own site. 8 The Tokyo Marathon's own site. 9 Art Basel's own Hong Kong page. 10 The Hong Kong Sevens' own site. **Omitted for want of a primary read:** the Singapore marathon's race dates, and three concerts whose every ticketing route returned 403 or 404.

THE TABLE · THREE ROOMS, TWO VERDICTS

Mr. CHEESECAKE opens its ION Orchard pop-up until 30 December

Koji Tamura's Tokyo brand trades only until 30 December, with whole frozen cakes from $62 and no permanent Singapore store planned.

Mr. CHEESECAKE opens on level three of ION Orchard today, and closes on 30 December. This desk flagged the pop-up when it was announced; what is new is that it is now trading, and that its makers say there is no plan for a permanent Singapore shop. The brand was founded in Tokyo in 2018 by Koji Tamura, who cooked at the three-starred Mirazur in Menton; it runs five stores in Japan and one in Hong Kong. The signature is a whole frozen cheesecake meant to be eaten at three stages — frozen, half-thawed, fully thawed — each tasting different. Whole cakes run $62 to $69. **It is too new to call:** it opens on this issue's cover date and carries no local review. Do not borrow the queue reports from a different Japanese cheesecake brand that popped up in the same mall in May. No pre-orders are published; go early.[1]

Habibi Kebs on Changi Road is the genuinely new room this fortnight, and the most useful address here for a mixed table: Berlin-style doner — salad- and sauce-heavy, packed into bread rather than served on a plate — and **halal-certified**. Chicken doner is $11, the mixed teller $14. Eatbook scored it **8 out of 10** on 10 November, praising the marinade, the portions and the price, and in the same breath called the room small, stuffy and badly ventilated, with no indoor seating; the reviewer recommended takeaway. The owner also said the minced beef in one dish will probably be phased out. A five-minute walk from Kembangan.[2]

SHAO @ Dempsey returns to this page for its verdict run, fourteen issues after its opening was logged, and the verdict is that there still isn't one. The group's fourth room makes a contemporary-Teochew seafood argument — marinated roe crab, barbecued roe crab, pan-seared Hokkaido cuttlefish in squid ink, poached crispy rice with seafood — all built for sharing, which is the honest case for taking a child and her grandparents at the same time. **No prices are published anywhere this desk could read, no review of this outlet exists, and the operator's own domain would not resolve from this build.** The group's earlier rooms have a record; this one still does not. Too new to call, for the second time — which is itself a finding about how long a Dempsey opening can stay unreviewed.[3]

POP-UP · TO 30 DEC · HALAL-CERTIFIED · TOO NEW TO CALL ×2

THE BUZZ · WHAT SINGAPORE'S FOOD PRESS MADE OF THESE THREE

One of the three carries a scored review and two do not, which is the honest shape of a November list. Eatbook's **8 out of 10** for Habibi Kebs comes with a named reservation in the same piece — a room the reviewer would rather take away from — and that pairing is the useful part: a score and a reason to distrust it. Mr. CHEESECAKE arrives with Tokyo pedigree, a Hong Kong outpost and a million cakes behind it, and no local verdict at all. **This desk could reach no social or forum chatter for any of the three: Reddit refused every request for the whole build, and two of the usual local food sites returned 403.**[4]

THE SCEPTIC · NOVEMBER'S "NEW OPENINGS" WERE MOSTLY NOT NEW

The honesty problem with a newest-openings column is that the roundups feeding it are not reliably about new rooms. One restaurant carried in a national food site's October 2026 list turned out to have been reviewed by that same site in **May 2025** — eighteen months old, still presented as an opening. Of the half-dozen candidates worked up for this page, **three had already run here** and one more was dropped because its name collides with a venue already recorded. **The test applied here:** a dated opening on the operator's own channel, or a scored review from somebody who ate there. One of today's three clears it outright. The other two are printed as what they are — too new to call — rather than dressed up as discoveries.[5]

SOURCES 1 Eatbook, 2 November 2026, and Honeycombers, 30 October, both read at source, for the pop-up dates, the level-three ION Orchard location, the founder's pedigree, the three-stage serving idea and the price list; **the two outlets differ on one flavour's price, and neither carries a review of the Singapore pop-up, which opens on this issue's cover date.** 2 Eatbook's review of 10 November 2026, read at source, for the score, the halal certification, the prices, the praise, the criticism of the room, the walking time and the owner's remark about the minced beef. 3 SassyMama's November 2026 listing, read at source, for the address, the concept and the dish list; **the operator's own domain would not resolve from this build, and the October opening reported by a second lifestyle site could not be read because that host returned 403 — so the opening date is reported, not verified.** 4 The reviews cited above. **Reddit and two local food sites were unreachable for this entire build; no sentiment has been invented to fill the gap.** 5 This desk's own cross-check of a national food site's October 2026 roundup against that site's own earlier review date, read at source, and of every candidate against `ledgers/table-ledger.md`.

THE LONG READ · KOREA'S MANAGED BENEFIT

South Korea capped manual therapy at 43,850 won and the money moved elsewhere

Seoul's health ministry fixed the price on 1 July 2026 and made patients pay 95 per cent of it. By August, claims for a cheap spray-and-stretch substitute had risen 218 per cent, on data released by Representative Kim Yoon.

On 30 July, a physiotherapy room in the Dongdaemun district of Seoul had two appointments in the book. Through June it had been busy. On 27 July, of roughly 150 patients who came through the clinic, one received 도수치료 — *dosu chiryo*, hands-on manual therapy, the most lucrative treatment in Korean medicine and, until four weeks earlier, the largest single item of private health spending in the country.[1]

To understand why a government would do this, you need one number. Korea's public health insurance deliberately does not cover everything; a private top-up market grew up to pay for the rest, and 36 million policies now stand behind it. In 2025 those insurers paid out 17 trillion won, of which **9.7 trillion — 57 per cent — went on treatments the state does not cover.** And within that, musculoskeletal claims reached **2.7 trillion won: more than cancer and heart and stroke care combined, at 2.6 trillion.** Korea's private insurers now pay more for having people's backs rubbed than for treating their tumours.[2]

What the ministry did on 1 July has no good English name, because it is not quite price control and not quite insurance. It created a new category inside the public fee schedule — 관리급여, a "managed benefit" — put manual therapy into it, fixed a single national price of **43,850 won** a session where clinics had been charging an average of around 110,000, and set the patient's share at **95 per cent**. The public insurer contributes about 2,193 won. It also capped sessions at two a week and fifteen a year, required basic physiotherapy to be tried first, and built a national system to count how many sessions each institution gives. Beyond the cap, a clinic may bill neither the insurer nor the patient.[3]

> ***A 95 per cent co-payment is not insurance. It is a price control wearing insurance's clothes.***

The effect was immediate and very large. National spending on manual therapy fell from **121.3 billion won** in March 2025 to **10.33 billion** in July 2026 — a fall of **91.5 per cent**. Monthly claims dropped from between 500,000 and 600,000 to 238,603. Hospitals fell 92.5 per cent, clinics 90.7. Measured against what it was built to do, the instrument worked within a month.[4]

Then it stopped working, in the way these things always stop working. By August, insurers' claim value for 신장분사치료 — a cheap spray-and-stretch procedure, trigger-point treatment with a coolant spray — had risen from 4.553 billion won to **14.465 billion, up 218 per cent year on year**, with the average claim per case doubling from about 31,900 won to 66,300. In the same month, manual-therapy claim value fell 96 per cent and its own average claim halved. The money did not leave. It changed its name.[5]

2.7tn v 2.6tn

WON PAID BY KOREA'S PRIVATE INSURERS IN 2025 FOR MUSCULOSKELETAL CARE, AGAINST CANCER AND HEART AND STROKE CARE COMBINED[2]

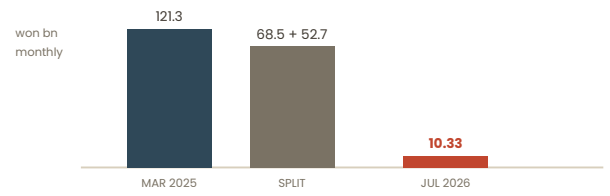
95%

THE PATIENT'S SHARE OF A TREATMENT THE STATE FORMALLY ADDED TO ITS OWN BENEFIT SCHEDULE[3]

SOURCES 1 Herald Economy, 5 August 2026, read at source, for the Dongdaemun clinic, the two bookings on 30 July and the one patient in roughly 150 on 27 July; the therapy-team head quoted there puts July revenue down 70 to 80 per cent. 2 The Financial Supervisory Service's 2025 private indemnity results, released 2–3 June 2026 and reported by Kyunghyang Shinmun and Newsis, **both read at source**, for the 17 trillion won of payouts, the 9.7 trillion and 57.1 per cent non-covered share, the 101.0 per cent loss ratio and the 2.7 trillion against 2.6 trillion comparison. **This desk read the reporting of the regulator's release rather than the release itself.** 3 The Ministry of Health and Welfare's own press release of 2 July 2026, read at source in the Korea Development Institute's policy mirror, and Medifonews, read at source, for the managed-benefit category, the 43,850-won price, the 95 per cent co-payment, the session caps, the prior-physiotherapy requirement, the counting system and the billing prohibition; the ~110,000-won average is Medifonews's figure. 4 Health Insurance Review and Assessment Service data released by Representative Han Ji-a and reported by SBS Biz, read at source, for the 121.3 billion to 10.33 billion fall, the claim counts and the hospital and clinic splits. 5 Five insurers' data released by Representative Kim Yoon and reported by SBS Biz, read at source. **This is one month, year on year, from five unnamed insurers released by an opposition legislator — not an official series, and flagged as such wherever it appears.**

The legal machinery matters, because it is what the fight is actually about. The ministry did not pass a law. It amended the enforcement decree of the existing health-insurance act, using a clause that lets it designate a selective benefit where "appropriate medical use management" is needed, and then created the managed-benefit sub-category inside a regime built for something else entirely. Selective benefit was designed as a way to part-fund promising treatments while the evidence matured. It has been repurposed as a way to price treatments the state has no intention of funding at all.[1]

That is the plaintiffs' case, and it is now before the Constitutional Court twice over. A challenge filed by the attorney Shin In-sik was **referred to the court's full bench on 22 July 2026**, arguing that the clause is an unconstitutional delegation of legislative power. The Korean Medical Association filed its own constitutional complaint on **22 September**, with patients as co-complainants; its chairman, Kim Taek-woo, called the policy a "위헌적 폭거" — an unconstitutional outrage. A separate group of clinical physiotherapists is collecting signatures to ask the Board of Audit and Inspection to audit the policy.[2]



National monthly spending on manual therapy, billions of won; the middle bar splits March 2025 into clinics and hospitals. *Meridian* original; figures released to the National Assembly.[3]

The people who lost their incomes are not the people the policy was aimed at. The orthopaedic clinic owners' association says between a fifth and a third of its members shut their physical-therapy rooms on the first day, its president saying current fees yield "no profit at all". But the association of physiotherapists — salaried staff, not clinic owners — surveyed about a thousand of its members and reported that **98 per cent saw a threat to their livelihood**. Of 348 logged cases, 161 were pay freezes or cuts, 106 were cut incentives, and **98 were forced resignations or dismissals**. Korea has discovered that uncovered care is not a loophole. It is an employer.[4]

The state stopped trying to buy this care and started annexing it.

There is a second front. On 6 May 2026 the insurers launched a fifth generation of indemnity policy, raising the patient's share of non-severe uncovered care from 30 to 50 per cent, cutting the cap on such claims from 50 million won to 10 million, pricing premiums about 30 per cent lower, and excluding manual therapy and shockwave treatment outright. Take-up on the first day was reported as flat. The state and the insurers are now pushing from opposite ends of the same market, and the thing between them is a list of procedure names.[5]

Three more treatments are already queued behind manual therapy. The policy committee that designated it in December 2025 named percutaneous epidural neuroplasty and radiation hyperthermia in the same breath, and deferred extracorporeal shockwave treatment to the doctors' own self-correction, under monitoring. Neuroplasty alone accounted for about a fifth of all insurance disputes in 2025. The queue is not a threat. It is a published schedule.[1]

The ministry itself has been plain about the purpose. Its minister framed the designation as preventing indiscriminate excessive treatment, which is a reasonable thing for a health ministry to want and an unusual thing to pursue with a price list for care it does not fund. What the policy committee has actually built is a procedure-by-procedure annexation, and the review body's own posture — settle this category, then move to the next — reads less like deterrence than like a schedule.[1]

98%

OF ABOUT A THOUSAND KOREAN PHYSIOTHERAPISTS SURVEYED WHO REPORTED THEIR LIVELIHOOD UNDER THREAT WITHIN WEEKS OF THE CAP[4]

SOURCES 1 The Ministry of Health and Welfare's own release of 2 July 2026, read at source in the Korea Development Institute's policy mirror, and Medifonews, read at source, for the enforcement-decree route, the managed-benefit sub-category and the December 2025 designation of the three items with shockwave deferred; Newsis, read at source, for the neuroplasty share of 2025 insurance disputes. 2 Newsis, 24 July 2026, read at source, for the referral of the constitutional challenge to the full bench on 22 July and the grounds argued; SBS Biz, read at source, for the Korean Medical Association's own complaint of 22 September and its chairman's characterisation, and for the physiotherapists' audit petition. **No ruling had been handed down when this issue closed.** 3 Health Insurance Review and Assessment Service figures released to Representative Han Ji-a and reported by SBS Biz, read at source. 4 Daily Medi, 2 and 3 July 2026, and Segye, 1 July, all read at source, for the orthopaedic association's closure estimate and its president's remark, and for the physiotherapists' survey and its case breakdown. **The one-fifth-to-one-third closure figure is the orthopaedic association's own count, which the outlet reporting it explicitly did not verify.** 5 BizWatch, 6 May 2026, read at source, for the fifth-generation policy terms and the first-day take-up.

The obvious reading of all this is that Korea cracked down on overtreatment. The more interesting one is that Korea has invented a category of medicine that sits inside the public fee schedule and almost entirely outside public payment. The insurer pays 2,193 won a session for the right to govern the other 41,657. That is not a benefit; it is jurisdiction, bought cheaply.[1]

This is the part that travels. Across Asia's cheap-public, large-private health systems — and Singapore is one of them — the binding constraint has stopped being how generous the covered package is. It is whether the state can set prices in the part of medicine it declined to pay for. Korea is the first to try it at scale, and the first six months show what it is really fighting. Not greed. Taxonomy.

Within eight weeks the money reappeared under a different procedure name, at a cheaper code whose average price promptly doubled. The arbitrage layer in a mixed health system is not the clinic; it is the code list. A government can only control what it can name, and naming is slower than renaming. That is why the policy committee's queue of further items reads less like deterrence and more like an admission: each designation buys perhaps a year before the traffic reroutes.

> ***A government can only control what it can name, and naming is slower than renaming.***

Two precedents say how this usually ends, and they disagree. Taiwan moved its national insurance to a capped global budget in 2002 and cut spending growth from around 13 per cent a year to about five — but squeezed consultations to a few minutes and pushed district hospitals to downsize. England set a unit price for health-service dentistry in 2006 below the cost of modern practice, and got exit rather than efficiency: by 2008 some 900,000 fewer patients were being seen, and the service has never recovered its coverage. The Taiwanese version relocates the pressure; the English version loses the provider. Korea's first six months look like the English one, with 98 per cent of a profession reporting their livelihood at risk.[2]

THE SCEPTIC · THE CASE THAT KOREA'S CAP IS WORKING

The ministry's own arithmetic undercuts the outrage. It says the average insurance-claimed course ran to twelve sessions, and that the fifteen-session cap covers 95 per cent of patients — so the limit binds on almost nobody, and what fell away was volume nobody could defend. The substitution does not yet offset: manual-therapy claims fell about 46 billion won in a single month while the replacement rose about 9.9 billion, so the balloon has taken back roughly a fifth. Musculoskeletal care is 2.7 trillion of 17 trillion in payouts, and robotic surgery, embolisation and focused ultrasound are all growing faster. The 218 per cent figure is one month, year on year, from five unnamed insurers released by an opposition legislator. And the academics counsel patience: one health-policy professor wants three to six months of monitoring before any verdict, another argues for a full procedure-code list under self-regulation rather than item-by-item state pricing.[3]

WHAT WOULD FALSIFY THIS READING

Three tests, all resolvable within a year. **One:** if by mid-2027 total physical-therapy claim value and the indemnity loss ratio both fall — not merely the capped item — then price control works and the balloon was noise. **Two:** if the Constitutional Court voids the delegating clause, the instrument dies and this becomes a separation-of-powers story rather than a health-financing one. **Three:** if the substitute's growth reverses without further regulation, the renaming was a transient rather than a mechanism. This desk will print whichever answer arrives.

The reason to watch it from here is not that Singapore is about to copy it. It is that every system which keeps public coverage narrow and lets private money fill the gap eventually discovers the same thing: the gap is not empty space. It has prices, staff, premises and a lobby. Korea has just found out what it costs to reach into it — and that the first thing the money does, when a price is fixed, is find a part of the body with a cheaper name.

SOURCES 1 The ministry's own release of 2 July 2026, read at source in the Korea Development Institute's policy mirror; the 2,193-won figure is this desk's arithmetic on the published 43,850-won price and 95 per cent patient share. 2 Taiwan's global-budget transition and England's dental contract are summarised from encyclopaedic accounts read at source, **each citing underlying sources this desk did not open; the United Kingdom parliamentary library briefing returned 403.** They are offered as analogies, not as evidence about Korea. 3 Segye, 1 July 2026, read at source, for the ministry's twelve-session average and its claim that fifteen sessions covers 95 per cent of patients; SBS Biz, 13 October, read at source, for the two academics' positions; the Financial Supervisory Service's 2025 results as reported, for the 2.7-trillion-of-17-trillion proportion and the faster-growing categories. **One caveat this desk could not resolve:** the same report that carries the 218 per cent rise also gives a total physical-therapy figure for August 2026 that is smaller than its own August 2025 figure for manual therapy alone, so the two series are evidently scoped differently and have not been combined here. **No first-hand Korean community-forum sentiment appears anywhere in this essay: every platform this desk tried refused the request, so all discourse above is local press and named organisations' own surveys, attributed as reported.**

THE LAST WORD

What the figures do not say

This is a straight news book — no theme imposed, after three issues that ran one. But reading it back, the same small silence turns up on desk after desk, and it is worth a paragraph because none of it was arranged.

America published an inflation report on Tuesday with no inflation rate in it, because nobody collected last October (p14). A Singapore publisher disclosed a breach as a percentage of a number it would not give (p5). A home-automation project opened a shop and published no rule by which anything could be refused shelf space (p8). Not one maker of stacked lunch boxes prints the thickness of its own steel (p6), and most will not name the grade either. Seven rebreather manufacturers publish a specification and no price (p16). A flagship headphone has been on sale for five days and for sale for a month with no measurement in existence (p10). Gardens by the Bay opens in sixteen days and has said “prices will be released soon” for six issues running (p19).

None of these is a scandal. Several have decent explanations. What they have in common is that the missing number is never the one that would embarrass nobody — and that the people who do publish, like a Japanese flask-maker printing a temperature at six hours against each model number (p6), tend to be the ones who actually know the answer.

Which is roughly the Korean lesson on p21, arrived at from the other end. Fix a price on something you have named, and within eight weeks the money is doing the same thing under a name you have not.

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A note on method. Read at source this edition: France’s own state cyber advisory CERTFR-2026-CTI-009; the Monetary Authority of Singapore’s gold-vaulting release and the Ministry of Home Affairs’ leadership announcement; TSMC’s October revenue release and its matching filing with the United States securities regulator, reconciled line by line; China’s commerce-ministry Announcement No. 48; Home Assistant’s own release post and changelog, and the forum thread objecting to it; Schiit’s, Pro-Ject’s and iFi’s own product pages; Phillips’ lot pages for lots 60 and 220; Box Office Mojo’s release and weekend tables; the United States Bureau of Labor Statistics’ October release and the Treasury’s own yield files; four journal records through the National Library of Medicine’s retrieval interface; the Health Promotion Board’s Nutri-Grade page; JJ-CCR’s published price list, Fathom’s and Dive Rite’s own stores and Seaskin’s lead-time page; a peer-reviewed rebreather fatality review in full; eleven promoters’ and venues’ own pages; Korea’s health ministry release and the reporting of its assembly disclosures. **Refused or unreachable, and said so on the page each time:** Reddit in every form, for the whole build, which is why no forum sentiment appears in this issue outside ScubaBoard and two makers’ own review walls; Wikimedia’s image servers, which rate-limited us throughout; Iranian state media; Forbes, Bloomberg and Reuters; Audio-Technica’s own site; Amazon; the South China Morning Post; Singapore’s own housing-board press index; and three Singapore ticketing routes, which is why three stadium concerts are not listed. **Held, not printed:** Christmas Wonderland’s prices, for the sixth issue running; any independent measurement of the Audio-Technica flagship, for the fourth; Samsung’s SmartThings price; the M1, Doctor Anywhere and SPH Media record counts; and any Korean Constitutional Court ruling.